POL309: Politics of the European Union

Department of Political Science | Diego Hernandez | Fall 2026 | M/W/F, 2-2:55pm, August 24th to December 17th, Frey Hall 305

Course Information

Why the European Union was created, how its institutions have evolved over time, and where the union is going.

This course offers a comprehensive introduction to the European Union (EU), exploring its political dynamics, historical foundations, and contemporary challenges. We will examine how the EU's evolving integration process influences current policies and debates, with an emphasis on the key actors, the motivations, and the mechanisms behind the construction of a collective Europe.

This course goes beyond a traditional survey course in European politics. The Department of Political Science at Stony Brook has a long tradition of excellence in political psychology and we will apply that tradition's insights in this course. In addition to giving students a thorough overview of the EU, its foundation and future directions, I provide students a social psychological framework for thinking critically about the EU project. We treat the question of a shared European identity as arising from our psychology and reinforced by social groups and political institutions, building from social identity theory to ask whether, when, and for whom "European" functions as a meaningful ingroup. We spend two weeks on the migration crisis: one on the politics and policy machinery, and one on the psychology of compassion and public response, centered on the September 2015 photographs of Alan Kurdi and what they reveal about how images of identifiable victims, and children in particular, move public sympathy in ways that statistics and a steady stream of images of adults do not. We additionally spend two weeks on the potential for eastern enlargement, examining how the EU has grown in the past and what stands between the current candidates and membership.

The course grounds these developments in theoretical frameworks from comparative politics, international relations, and political psychology, and is intended to help prepare students for advanced studies or occupations in European affairs, international relations, international public policy, or political science.

SBC Designation: SBS+ Social and Behavioral Sciences | Credits: 3 units | Pre-requisites, Co-requisites: U2 or higher standing; Advisory pre-requisite: POL101 and 103, DEC I | Required grade: A through D.

Instructor Information

Diego Hernandez, PhD Candidate
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Office hours Wednesdays, 3:10 to 4:15pm, or by appointment, booked at:
https://diegohernandezpolpsych.github.io/schedule.html

Course Objectives

1. Describe the structure, roles, and functions of major EU institutions.
2. Evaluate how EU institutions collaborate and compete in the policymaking process.
3. Investigate major policy areas, including economic policy, internal governance, and the EU's global role.
4. Apply social identity theory and related social psychological frameworks to explain the formation, strength, and limits of a shared European identity, including the case of Brexit.
5. Analyze how visual media and documented psychological tendencies, including the identifiable victim effect and compassion fade, shaped public responses to the European migration crisis.
6. Construct and defend normative arguments about the role of empathy in public policy.
7. Assess the mechanics of EU enlargement and weigh the possibilities and constraints surrounding eastern expansion.
8. Conduct independent research on member and non-member states and formulate arguments supported by factual evidence related to EU political dynamics.
9. Produce structured, analytical essays related to EU politics.

Required Course Materials

Our textbook for this course is John McCormick's *Understanding the European Union: A Concise Introduction*, 8th edition (2021). Students are required to obtain a copy. All other required readings, including the journal articles and any required book excerpts listed in the course schedule, will be posted as PDFs on Brightspace at no cost to you.

Recommended Course Materials

Students who want a more detailed institutional treatment may consult Simon Hix and Bjorn Hoyland, *The Political System of the European Union* (2022, 4th edition). For the identity unit, Thomas Risse's *A Community of Europeans?* (2010) is the book to buy if you buy one for use beyond this course. Readings marked "Recommended" in the schedule are not required, but they may be used in support of your writing assignments and final paper, and they mark the paths I would take this course down with more time. Each week I will also compile a list of resources on Brightspace that students may find helpful.

How to Communicate and Interact in this Course

Regular, professional, and respectful communication is essential, in the classroom and out of it. The best way to reach me outside of class is email; the best way to discuss your work in depth is office hours.

Attendance and Preparedness

We meet Monday, Wednesday, and Friday for 55-minute lectures. Because 55 minutes is short, you must arrive promptly. Your participation grade will consider excessive absences and tardiness. Complete each week's required readings before Monday's lecture; the week's sessions build on them. Most Fridays are interactive and designed to facilitate “hands-on” learning: class discussion, the Week 11 debate, and case-study applications. Any assigned videos should be watched before the session they are listed under.

Response Time and Feedback on Assignments

You should expect email turnaround time of less than 24 hours Mondays through Fridays. If you email me and I do not respond in less than 48 hours during the week, please send me a follow-up email. On your assignments, from deadline to receiving your grade, expect that it will take no less than a full week.

Grading Scale

A = 93+ | A- = 90-92 | B+ = 87-89 | B = 83-86 | B- = 80-82 | C+ = 77-79 | C = 73-76 | C- = 70-72 | D+ = 67-69 | D = 63-66 | D- = 60-62 | F = 0-60

For all course assignments, interactive rubrics and a grade calculator are available on my website https://diegohernandezpolpsych.github.io/index.html. These tools operate in your browser; they do not store or send any information beyond your machine.

Assignments

Writing Assignment 1: The EU in the News (15% of your grade; due end of Week 5)

Please look through headlines on https://www.euractiv.com, an independent pan-European media network specialized in EU affairs, to get a sense of some of the issues that are currently evolving in EU politics. Your task is to write a 500 word (minimum) reflection on how the EU could address the issue. First, describe what's happening and who is involved. Then, choose two EU institutions from our institutions unit, and write about how those institutions and their political actors may engage the issue you read about in the news. In writing the piece, you can be as creative as you want after providing these basics. You may, although it is not necessary, get into character as an EU official within your selected institution and explain what you and your institution can do to help address the issue. You will be graded on how well you demonstrate that you are familiar with the two institutions you choose to highlight. At the end of your short essay, include a link to the article on the Euractiv website, and cite any sources you use. Submit to Brightspace by Friday of Week 5 at 11:59pm. Some Euractiv articles will be behind a paywall. If you encounter one of these on an issue you are interested in, you may find articles about that issue on alternate, reputable websites, but you must ask me for approval first. Do not pay for access to any articles for the purpose of completing this assignment.

Writing Assignment 2: The Image and the Crisis (20% of your grade; due end of Week 11)

This assignment follows our unit on the psychology of the migration crisis. Select one widely circulated visual from the 2015-2016 European migration crisis. You may choose one of the Alan Kurdi photographs or another image we discuss in lecture. In a 500 word (minimum) reflection, do three things. First, describe the image and the context in which it circulated. Second, explain the public and political response it produced, citing at least one concrete outcome (donations, policy statements, media coverage patterns, or public opinion data). Third, use at least two of the assigned readings from Week 11 to explain why this image moved audiences the way it did, or why its effect faded. Engage the concepts directly: the identifiable victim effect, compassion fade, psychic numbing, or the perceptual pull of children's faces. I am not asking you what the image made you feel. I am asking you to explain, with evidence, why images like it reliably do

more work on public opinion than statistics or images of adults. Submit to Brightspace by Saturday of Week 11 at 11:59pm.

A note on content: this assignment and the Week 11 readings concern the death of a child. Engage with the material seriously and respectfully. If you would prefer an alternative prompt for personal reasons, email me and I will provide one, no explanation required.

Participation (10%) and the Empathy Debate (10% of your grade; debate held Friday of Week 11)

Participation credit rewards informed contribution to class discussion across the semester. There are no reading quizzes in this course; regular discussion is where I check that the reading is getting done, and contributions that engage the week's assigned readings count for more than contributions that do not.

There will be a structured in-class debate on Friday of Week 11: is empathy a good guide to policy? You will be assigned in advance to one of two sides. One side defends empathy-driven response to crises like 2015 as democratically legitimate and motivationally necessary; the other defends the position Paul Bloom stakes out in *Against Empathy*: that empathy is innumerate, biased toward the identifiable and the similar, and that refugee policy must move beyond eliciting empathy if it is to survive the fading of the image. Come with at least one prepared argument grounded in the assigned readings; strong contributions will convert the psychology from Weeks 10 and 11 into a normative claim rather than restating it. Any students with a documented absence on debate day will complete a short, written version of their side's brief.

Individual Student Meetings (5% of your grade; Weeks 8-12)

You must schedule a one-to-one meeting with me to discuss your final paper during weeks 8, 9, 10, 11, or week 12 in my office (N709 SBS) or over Zoom by request. In advance of this meeting, please formalize your final paper ideas as much as possible. These meetings are to help you so that you receive a good grade and produce a quality paper that you can potentially expand upon in work beyond this course. The earlier you schedule this, the better.

Final Paper (40% of your grade; due December 14th at 11:59PM EST)

For your final paper, you may choose any of the three options below:

Option 1: Select a current member country and discuss its history in the European Union, what the landmark events were that led to it joining, the reasons, etc. This requires doing research on your own. What do you think the future looks like for this country's membership? Are there any internal crises or movements in public opinion within this country, neighboring countries, or the EU that may threaten political stability? I want your opinion, but it needs to be backed up by facts, and you need to discuss the institutions, political actors, and processes of politics in the EU as you make your case.

Option 2: Select a current non-member country and discuss why the country wants to, or may want to, join the EU, or not. What are the benefits, and what compromises would the country have to make to be granted entry? This option allows you to think about geopolitics, a Europe in the world, and it pairs naturally with our Weeks 12 and 13 on enlargement. Same as above: you need to show that you understand the institutions, key actors, and the political process of the EU. You'll need to overview historical directions or events in the country's history to

effectively make your argument. The United Kingdom, as the only country to leave, is admissible under this option if you engage the Week 9 material.

Option 3: Write an analytical paper on European identity or the public response to the migration crisis that applies the social psychological frameworks from Weeks 7 through 11 to a specific country, event, or campaign. For example: why has European identity remained thin in one member state and thick in another, how did identity alignment produce the Brexit result, or how did the visual framing of the 2015 crisis shape a specific national policy debate? Papers choosing this option must engage the assigned social psychology readings substantively, not decoratively, and must still demonstrate command of EU institutions and processes.

Whichever you choose, write a typed paper in MLA or APA format, 7-8 pages, double spaced, size 12 font. Your paper must be submitted to Brightspace by the deadline above. You must substantially reference the textbook in your final paper.

Course Schedule

Lectures meet in person each Monday, Wednesday, and Friday for 55 minutes. The possibility exists that unforeseen events will make schedule changes necessary, including that class will be held online via Zoom or asynchronous for a class meeting. Some changes have already been noted below. Any changes will be clearly communicated in Brightspace Announcements and through Stony Brook email in advance. Please ensure your notifications are turned on in Brightspace settings, so you receive announcements promptly.

An asterisk (*) denotes a week with an assignment due. Readings marked "Recommended" are not required, but they are fair game for you to use as additional sources in your writing assignments and final paper.

Unit I: Foundations (Weeks 1-6)

Week 1: The Idea of Europe, the Foundation of the Union

Monday (8/24): Course introduction: the syllabus, and why a political psychologist teaches the EU this way.

Wednesday (8/26): The idea of Europe: from myth and empires to fascism and the wars of the early 20th century.

Friday (8/28): Postwar reconstruction and early political movement towards union.

Readings:

1. Chapter 2, "The Idea of Europe" in McCormick's *Understanding the European Union*.
2. Primary documents on Brightspace: Winston Churchill, speech at the University of Zurich, September 19, 1946; and the Schuman Declaration, May 9, 1950.
3. Della Sala, Vincent. 2010. "Political Myth, Mythology and the European Union." *Journal of Common Market Studies* 48(1): 1-19.
4. Read before Friday: Judt, Tony. 1996. The Past is Another Country: Myth and Memory in Postwar Europe. *Theoria: A Journal of Social and Political Theory, (87),* 36–69. *link*.

Recommended: Spinelli, Altiero, and Ernesto Rossi. 1941. "The Ventotene Manifesto". link.

Recommended: Anderson, Benedict. 1983. *Imagined Communities: Reflections on the Origin and Spread of Nationalism*. London: Verso. Introduction and Chapter 1.

Recommended: Gerard Delanty, *Inventing Europe: Idea, Identity, Reality*. Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan, 1995.

Recommended: Bottici, Chiara, and Benoît Challand. 2013. *Imagining Europe: Myth, Memory, and Identity*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.

Recommended: Flood, Christopher. 2002. *Political Myth: A Theoretical Introduction*. London: Routledge.

This week we read the founders' own words. Churchill calls for "a kind of United States of Europe" from a country that would not join it for decades; Schuman proposes pooling coal and steel to make war between France and Germany materially impossible. Della Sala questions whether a study of European institutions without looking at how narrative and emotion shapes them leads us, and policymakers, to miss the glue that holds the political system together. Judt provides a skeptic's view of the project: "Europe" is little more than a story its elites tell, while European publics sleepwalk, which is an argument we will spend Weeks 7 through 9 questioning. The Ventotene Manifesto, recommended, drafted in a fascist prison, is Wednesday's interwar federalism in primary form, and Anderson's argument returns in Week 7 when we ask whether Europe can be imagined the way nations are.

Week 2: The Political History of the European Union

Monday (8/31): Coal and steel: the ECSC, the Treaty of Rome, and the logic of binding.

Wednesday (9/2, *class will be asynchronous & online*): From the empty chair crisis to Maastricht.

Friday (9/4, *class will be asynchronous & online*): Amsterdam, Nice, Lisbon: the EU's present structure.

Readings:

1. Chapter 3, "The Evolution of the EU."
2. Monnet, Jean. 1978. *Memoirs*. Garden City, NY: Doubleday. (Excerpt on Brightspace).
3. Primary documents on Brightspace: Preamble to the Treaty of Rome, March 25, 1957; and Charles de Gaulle, press conference vetoing British accession, January 14, 1963.
4. Milward, Alan S. 1992. *The European Rescue of the Nation-State*. London: Routledge (Excerpt on Brightspace)

   Recommended: Chapter 1, "What is the European Union."

The primary documents continue last week's habit of reading the founders in their own words, and both plant seeds for later. The Treaty of Rome preamble contains the most argued-over words in EU history, "ever closer union," a phrase we will meet again in the theories week, the Brexit week, and the final week of the course. De Gaulle's 1963 veto of British membership is Wednesday's intergovernmental turn in primary form, and it reads very differently once you know how the British story ends in Week 9. The other readings offer what me may see as two opposing memories of the same events: Monnet, the founder, recalling integration as a method for transcending the nation, and Milward, the skeptical historian,

arguing that integration was how postwar nation-states rescued themselves. Keep that dispute in hand; it leads into Haas versus Moravcsik next week, and Milward connects to Judt's critique last week that nationalism and pride require a forgetfulness of collective memory, as in, "the past is another country", that makes it difficult for the mass public to believe the story EU elites are trying to sell.

Week 3: Theories of European Integration

Monday (9/7): Labor Day, no class.

Wednesday (9/9): Neofunctionalism: Haas and the logic of spillover,

Intergovernmentalism: Hoffmann's rejoinder and Moravcsik's grand bargains.

Friday (9/11): Postfunctionalism: identity enters the story.

Interactive: Which theory best explains the last decade?

Readings:

1. Haas, Ernst B. 1958. *The Uniting of Europe*. Introduction (excerpt on Brightspace).
2. Hoffmann, Stanley. 1966. "Obstinate or Obsolete? The Fate of the Nation-State and the Case of Western Europe." *Daedalus* 95(3): 862-915 (excerpt on Brightspace).
3. Moravcsik, Andrew. 1998. *The Choice for Europe*. Chapter 1 (excerpt on Brightspace).
4. Hooghe, Liesbet, and Gary Marks. 2009. "A Postfunctionalist Theory of European Integration: From Permissive Consensus to Constraining Dissensus." *British Journal of Political Science* 39(1): 1-23.

   Recommended: Hansen, Peo, and Stefan Jonsson. 2014. *Eurafrica: The Untold History of European Integration and Colonialism*. London: Bloomsbury Academic.

   Recommended: Checkel, Jeffrey T. 2005. "International Institutions and Socialization in Europe: Introduction and Framework." *International Organization* 59(4): 801-826.

Why does integration happen at all? This week we compare the big theories: neofunctionalist spillover, intergovernmental bargaining, and the postfunctionalist claim that mass identity politics now constrains what elites can build. Hold on to Hooghe and Marks. Their argument that integration has collided with national identity helps connect the institutional half of this course to the social psychology unit in Weeks 7 through 9.

Week 4: Institutions of the European Union I: The Executive Machinery

Monday (9/14): The European Commission: the engine and its limits.

Wednesday (9/16): The European Council and the Council of the EU: who decides, when and on what?

Friday (9/18): Reading Day: ***No class, please use the time to catch up on readings.***

Readings:

1. Chapter 4, "The European Institutions."
2. Watch before Monday: European Commission: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nZqG4U-X1_s
3. Watch before Wednesday: European Council: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9Y4xzsOvybA

4. Watch before Wednesday: Council of the European Union: https://youtu.be/_CxrVizxlGA?si=TIDsDimFFc_QXBO

*Week 5: Institutions of the European Union II: Parliament, Law, and the Policy Process

Monday (9/21): The European Parliament: the only directly elected chamber.

Wednesday (9/23): The Court of Justice and the quiet "constitutionalization" of Europe.

Friday (9/25):

Interactive: Following a bill: the ordinary legislative procedure, start to finish.

Readings:

1. Chapter 6, "The EU Policy Process."
2. Watch before Monday: European Parliament: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WoGvVUtRnoU
3. Watch before Wednesday: EU Financial System: https://youtu.be/QsLOm9vU1bA?si=IjLVZqcVrE6lgWwn
4. Watch before Friday: EU Laws: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8C0Kq7ioOpk

   Recommended: Hix and Hoyland, *The Political System of the European Union*, chapters on legislative and judicial politics (excerpt on Brightspace).

   Recommended: Puetter, Uwe. 2012. "Europe's Deliberative Intergovernmentalism: The Role of the Council and European Council in EU Economic Governance." *Journal of European Public Policy* 19(2): 161-178.

Writing Assignment 1 (The EU in the News) due Friday 9/25 at 11:59pm on Brightspace.

Week 6: The Single Market and Economic Policy

Monday (9/28): The single market: economic freedoms and its political frictions.

Wednesday (9/30): Economic and monetary union: a currency without a treasury.

Friday (10/2): The eurozone crisis and its legacies.

Readings:

1. Chapter 7, "Economic Policy."

   Recommended: Costas Lapavitsas, *Crisis in the Eurozone*. London: Verso, 2012.

   Recommended: Frieden, Jeffry, and Stefanie Walter. 2017. "Understanding the Political Economy of the Eurozone Crisis." *Annual Review of Political Science* 20: 371-390.

   Recommended: Matthijs, Matthias, and Mark Blyth, eds. 2015. *The Future of the Euro*. Oxford: Oxford University Press (introduction).

   Recommended: Böröcz, József. 2009. *The European Union and Global Social Change: A Critical Geopolitical-Economic Analysis*. London: Routledge.

Friday's lecture bridges to the identity unit: the Greek crisis is also a story of creditor and debtor publics developing hostile images of one another. Solidarity is easy to legislate and harder to feel.

Unit II: The Social Psychology of European Identity (Weeks 7-9)

Week 7: Foundations: Social Identity Theory and Political Identity

Monday (10/5): Social identity theory and the minimal group experiments.

Wednesday (10/7): From social to political identity: Huddy's critique, and when identities are adopted rather than merely available.

Friday (10/9): The EU and its citizens: applying the framework to Europe.

Readings:

1. Tajfel, Henri, and John C. Turner. 1979. "An Integrative Theory of Intergroup Conflict." In *The Social Psychology of Intergroup Relations*, eds. William G. Austin and Stephen Worchel. Monterey, CA: Brooks/Cole.
2. Huddy, Leonie. 2001. "From Social to Political Identity: A Critical Examination of Social Identity Theory." *Political Psychology* 22(1): 127-156.
3. Chapter 5, "The EU and its Citizens."

   Recommended: Brewer, Marilynn B. 1991. "The Social Self: On Being the Same and Different at the Same Time." *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin* 17(5): 475-482.

   Recommended: Yuki, M. 2003. "Intergroup Comparison versus Intragroup Relationships: A Cross-Cultural Examination of Social Identity Theory in North American and East Asian Cultural Contexts." *Social Psychology Quarterly* 66(2): 166–183.

   Recommended: Yuki, Maddux, Brewer, and Takemura. 2005. "Cross-Cultural Differences in Relationship- and Group-Based Trust." *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin* 31(1): 48–62.

This week we step out of political science and into social psychology. Tajfel and Turner's minimal group experiments showed that even arbitrary group assignments produce ingroup favoritism. If trivial categories can do that, what should a category like "European" be able to do, and why has it done so little for so many? Huddy's critique gives us the tools to ask when an identity is actually adopted rather than merely available. Brewer's optimal distinctiveness argument, recommended, explains why a superordinate European identity can feel identity-threatening rather than identity-expanding.

Week 8: Is There a European Identity? Identities, Cleavages, and Cross-Cutting Issues

Monday (10/12): Fall Break, no class.

Wednesday (10/14): Nested identities: Risse's onion and the marble cake; Civic versus cultural European identity; what Eurobarometer can and cannot measure.

Friday (10/16): Identity complexity and the transnational cleavage: when memberships align, identities harden.

Readings:

1. Risse, Thomas. 2010. *A Community of Europeans? Transnational Identities and Public Spheres*. Ithaca: Cornell University Press. Chapter 1.
2. Bruter, Michael. 2005. *Citizens of Europe? The Emergence of a Mass European Identity*. Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan (excerpt on Brightspace).

3. Roccas, Sonia, and Marilynn B. Brewer. 2002. "Social Identity Complexity." *Personality and Social Psychology Review* 6(2): 88-106.
4. El-Tayeb, Fatima. 2011. *European Others: Queering Ethnicity in Postnational Europe*. Minneapolis: University of Minnesota Press. Introduction.
5. Hooghe, Liesbet, and Gary Marks. 2018. "Cleavage Theory Meets Europe's Crises: Lipset, Rokkan, and the Transnational Cleavage." *Journal of European Public Policy* 25(1): 109-135.

   Recommended: Checkel, Jeffrey T., and Peter J. Katzenstein, eds. 2009. *European Identity*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press. Introduction.

   Recommended: Pettigrew, Thomas F., and Linda R. Tropp. 2006. "A Meta-Analytic Test of Intergroup Contact Theory." *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology* 90(5): 751-783.

   Recommended: Kuhn, Theresa. 2015. *Experiencing European Integration: Transnational Lives and European Identity*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.

Risse argues that many Europeans hold nested identities: national first, European second, like layers of an onion. Bruter separates the civic components of European identity (attachment to the EU as a political system) from the cultural ones (attachment to Europe as a community of values and heritage). As you read, keep Eurobarometer's identity items in mind and ask what these surveys can and cannot capture.

The second half of the week connects identity psychology to the structure of EU public opinion. Recall the minimal group paradigm from Week 7: if arbitrary categories with no history and no stakes produce ingroup bias, what should we expect from categories carrying centuries of national meaning? Treat the minimal group findings as a baseline, not as a model of European cleavages, which are anything but minimal. The research that grew out of that paradigm then does the analytical work. Roccas and Brewer show that when a person's group memberships cross-cut one another, identification with any single group loosens and intergroup bias declines; when memberships align, identities harden. This is the psychological microfoundation for an old claim in political science, running back to Lipset and Rokkan, that cross-cutting cleavages moderate political conflict while reinforcing cleavages polarize it. Hooghe and Marks argue that Europe's new transnational cleavage over immigration, integration, and national sovereignty is combustible for exactly this reason: education, place, and identity increasingly line up on the same side rather than cutting across one another. As you read, ask where "European" fits. Is it a superordinate identity that cross-cuts national attachments and softens conflict, or has it become one pole of the new cleavage itself? The recommended readings mark the optimistic path: contact theory, and Kuhn's uncomfortable finding that the Europeans who use free movement are disproportionately the already mobile and highly educated. Students considering Option 3 for the final paper will find this material a ready-made framework. Schedule your final paper meeting with me this week or in the next two weeks.

Week 9: Brexit: Identity, Cleavages, and Exit

Monday (10/19): The awkward partner: Britain's membership from accession to Bloomberg speech.

Wednesday (10/21): The referendum: who voted Leave, and why interests alone cannot explain it.

Friday (10/23): The campaign as applied social identity theory; the aftermath.

Interactive: did the cleavage argument pass its test?

Readings:

1. Hobolt, Sara B. 2016. "The Brexit Vote: A Divided Nation, a Divided Continent." *Journal of European Public Policy* 23(9): 1259-1277.
2. Goodwin, Matthew J., and Oliver Heath. 2016. "The 2016 Referendum, Brexit and the Left Behind: An Aggregate-Level Analysis of the Result." *The Political Quarterly* 87(3): 323-332.

   Recommended: Sobolewska, Maria, and Robert Ford. 2020. *Brexitland: Identity, Diversity and the Reshaping of British Politics*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.

   Recommended: Norris, Pippa, and Ronald Inglehart. 2019. *Cultural Backlash: Trump, Brexit, and Authoritarian Populism*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press (excerpt).

   Recommended: Valluvan, Sivamohan. 2019. *The Clamour of Nationalism: Race and Nation in Twenty-First-Century Britain*. Manchester: Manchester University Press.

   Nadine El-Enany, *(B)ordering Britain: Law, Race and Empire*. Manchester: Manchester University Press, 2020.

   Recommended: De Vries, Catherine E. 2018. *Euroscepticism and the Future of European Integration*. Oxford: Oxford University Press (excerpt).

   Recommended: Givens, Terri E. 2020. "Immigration, Race and the Radical Right: Politics and Policy from Colonialism to Brexit." *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies* 58(3): 514-526.

Week 8 ended by asking whether "European" cross-cuts national identity or has become one pole of the transnational cleavage. Brexit is the case where that question got answered at the ballot box. Hobolt shows the referendum sorted voters by education, age, and identity rather than by traditional party allegiance, which is Roccas and Brewer's identity alignment story playing out at national scale. In lecture we will walk through the Leave campaign's identity appeals as applied social identity theory: making "British" and "European" feel like competing rather than nested categories. De Vries, recommended, adds the benchmark theory of Euroskepticism: citizens judge the EU against an imagined national alternative, and in 2016 a majority preferred the benchmark.

Unit III: Crisis Politics and the Migration Crisis (Weeks 10-11)

Week 10: The Migration Crisis I: Politics, Policy, and Public Opinion

Monday (10/26): Schengen, free movement, and the asylum architecture before the storm.

Wednesday (10/28): 2015 and the collapse of Dublin; policy responses: relocation quotas, the EU-Turkey Statement, and the solidarity problem.

Friday (10/30): Guest lecture by Chloe Landis, Director of Education at Long Beach Museum of Art (Long Beach, California) on the migrant and refugee beyond news media; how artists explore belonging, and the places and spaces of "home".

Readings:

1. Chapter 8, "Internal Policies".
2. Niemann, Arne, and Natascha Zaun. 2018. "EU Refugee Policies and Politics in Times of Crisis: Theoretical and Empirical Perspectives." *Journal of Common Market Studies* 56(1): 3-22.

3. Primary documents on Brightspace: overview of the Dublin III Regulation and the March 2016 EU-Turkey Statement.
4. Kirişci, Kemal. 2014. Syrian Refugees and Turkey's Challenges: Going beyond Hospitality. Washington, DC: Brookings Institution.

   Recommended: Hainmueller, Jens, and Daniel J. Hopkins. 2014. "Public Attitudes Toward Immigration." *Annual Review of Political Science* 17: 225-249.

   Recommended: Bansak, Kirk, Jens Hainmueller, and Dominik Hangartner. 2016. "How Economic, Humanitarian, and Religious Concerns Shape European Attitudes Toward Asylum Seekers." *Science* 354(6309): 217-222.

   Recommended: Adamson, Fiona B., and Gerasimos Tsourapas. 2019. "Migration Diplomacy in World Politics." *International Studies Perspectives* 20(2): 113-128.

   Recommended: Geddes, Andrew, and Peter Scholten. 2016. The Politics of Migration and Immigration in Europe, 2nd ed. London: Sage.

In 2015, over one million people crossed into Europe, most fleeing the Syrian civil war. Monday and Wednesday cover the policy story and the formation of public attitudes: why Dublin collapsed, why relocation quotas failed, how the EU-Turkey deal worked, and what the crisis revealed about solidarity among member states. The recommended review by Hainmueller and Hopkins shows that symbolic and sociotropic concerns beat personal economic self-interest in explaining immigration attitudes, and Bansak and colleagues use a conjoint experiment on 18,000 Europeans to show which asylum-seeker attributes move evaluations. Keep that baseline in hand: next week asks why a single photograph moved publics when years of arrivals had not. Friday's class will be a guest lecture which will refocus us to consider the people: the migrants, the refugees, and how their lives, stories, identities, and futures cannot be summed up by statistics, and how conversations on border policies and immigration miss their humanity.

*Week 11: The Migration Crisis II: Alan Kurdi, the Psychology of Compassion, and the Empathy Debate

Content note: this week's material concerns the death of a child and images of that death. Lecture will discuss the photographs, but I will not require you to view them.

Monday (11/2): The image: September 2, 2015, and the empirical record of what followed.

Wednesday (11/4): Mechanisms: identifiable victims, psychic numbing, compassion fade, the pull of children's faces, and the mirror neuron claim evaluated.

Friday (11/6):

Full class: In-class structured debate: is empathy a good guide to policy? (Bloom versus the defenders of empathic response.)

*Writing Assignment 2 (The Image and the Crisis) due **Saturday** 11/7 at 11:59pm on Brightspace.*

Readings:

1. Slovic, Paul, Daniel Vastfjall, Arvid Erlandsson, and Robin Gregory. 2017. "Iconic Photographs and the Ebb and Flow of Empathic Response to Humanitarian Disasters." *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* 114(4): 640-644.

2. Small, Deborah A., George Loewenstein, and Paul Slovic. 2007. "Sympathy and Callousness: The Impact of Deliberative Thought on Donations to Identifiable and Statistical Victims." *Organizational Behavior and Human Decision Processes* 102(2): 143-153.
3. Vis, Farida, and Olga Goriunova, eds. 2015. *The Iconic Image on Social Media: A Rapid Research Response to the Death of Aylan Kurdi*. Visual Social Media Lab (selections on Brightspace).
4. Bloom, Paul. 2016. *Against Empathy: The Case for Rational Compassion*. New York: Ecco (excerpt on Brightspace). Required for Friday's debate.

   Recommended: Chouliaraki, Lilie, and Tijana Stolic. 2017. "Rethinking Media Responsibility in the Refugee 'Crisis': A Visual Typology of European News." *Media, Culture & Society* 39(8): 1162-1177.

   Recommended: Rajaram, Prem Kumar. 2002. "Humanitarianism and Representations of the Refugee." *Journal of Refugee Studies* 15(3): 247-264.

   Recommended: Nayeri, Dina. *The Ungrateful Refugee: What Immigrants Never Tell You*. Edinburgh: Canongate, 2019.

   Recommended: Slovic, Paul. 2007. "'If I Look at the Mass I Will Never Act': Psychic Numbing and Genocide." *Judgment and Decision Making* 2(2): 79-95.

   Recommended: Vastfjall, Daniel, Paul Slovic, Marcus Mayorga, and Ellen Peters. 2014. "Compassion Fade: Affect and Charity Are Greatest for a Single Child in Need." *PLOS ONE* 9(6): e100115.

   Recommended: Glocker, Melanie L., et al. 2009. "Baby Schema in Infant Faces Induces Cuteness Perception and Motivation for Caretaking in Adults." *Ethology* 115(3): 257-263.

   Recommended: Bleiker, Roland, David Campbell, Emma Hutchison, and Xzarina Nicholson. 2013. "The Visual Dehumanisation of Refugees." *Australian Journal of Political Science* 48(4): 398-416.

   Recommended: Rizzolatti, Giacomo, and Laila Craighero. 2004. "The Mirror-Neuron System." *Annual Review of Neuroscience* 27: 169-192; paired with an excerpt from Gregory Hickok, *The Myth of Mirror Neurons* (2014), as a corrective.

   Recommended: Sontag, Susan. 2003. *Regarding the Pain of Others*. New York: Farrar, Straus and Giroux.

   Recommended: Mayblin, Lucy, and Joe Turner. 2021. *Migration Studies and Colonialism*. Cambridge: Polity Press.

   Recommended: Isakjee, Arshad, Thom Davies, Jelena Obradović-Wochnik, and Karolína Augustová. 2020. "Liberal Violence and the Racial Borders of the European Union." *Antipode* 52(6): 1751-1773.

On September 2, 2015, photographs of three-year-old Alan Kurdi, drowned on a beach near Bodrum, Turkey, circulated worldwide within hours. Slovic and colleagues document what followed: donations to refugee causes surged dramatically, then decayed back to baseline within weeks, even as the death toll kept climbing. This week asks why. Why did one photographed child accomplish what a steady stream of images of adults, and years of casualty statistics, could not? The readings point to several mechanisms:

the identifiable victim effect (a single named person elicits more sympathy than statistical lives), psychic numbing and compassion fade (sympathy does not scale with the number of victims, and can even decline), and the distinct perceptual and motivational pull of children's faces, which signal innocence, non-agency, and vulnerability in ways adult faces do not. Some commentators reached for mirror neurons to explain the empathic jolt of the image; the recommended neuroscience pairing lets us evaluate that claim critically rather than repeat it, since the mirror neuron account of empathy is contested.

During our Friday lecture, we will convert the psychology into a normative argument. The Bloom excerpt is required reading for the debate: he argues that empathy is innumerate, biased toward the identifiable and the similar, exactly the properties the week's evidence documents, and therefore a poor basis for planning public policy. Sides are chosen or assigned in advance; see the Participation and the Empathy Debate section above.

Unit IV: Enlargement and Europe in the World (Weeks 12-15)

Week 12: Enlargement I: How the EU Grows

Monday (11/9): The Copenhagen criteria and the mechanics of accession.

Wednesday (11/11): Conditionality as the EU's most powerful foreign policy tool; the 2004 "big bang".

Friday (11/13): Lessons of the EU's "big bang", cautionary and otherwise.

Readings:

1. Review the enlargement sections of Chapter 3 in McCormick.
2. Schimmelfennig, Frank, and Ulrich Sedelmeier. 2004. "Governance by Conditionality: EU Rule Transfer to the Candidate Countries of Central and Eastern Europe." *Journal of European Public Policy* 11(4): 661-679.
3. Vachudova, Milada Anna. 2005. *Europe Undivided: Democracy, Leverage, and Integration After Communism*. Oxford: Oxford University Press (excerpt on Brightspace).

   Recommended: Jan Zielonka, *Europe as Empire: The Nature of the Enlarged European Union*. Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2006.

How does a club of six become a union of twenty-seven? This week covers the mechanics: the Copenhagen criteria, accession chapters, and conditionality as the EU's most powerful foreign policy tool. The 2004 "big bang" enlargement to Central and Eastern Europe is our central case, both as the high-water mark of the EU's transformative power and as the source of lessons, some cautionary, that shape enlargement debates today.

Week 13: Enlargement II: Eastern Expansion Today: Candidates and Constraints

Monday (11/16): Wartime candidacies: Ukraine, Moldova, Georgia.

Wednesday (11/18): The Western Balkans; absorption capacity and the budget math of expansion.

Friday (11/20): The rule-of-law constraint: Hungary, Poland, and the authoritarian equilibrium.

Readings:

1. Anghel, Veronica, and Jelena Dzankic. 2023. "Wartime EU: Consequences of the Russia-Ukraine War on the Enlargement Process." *Journal of European Integration* 45(3): 487-501.

2. Kelemen, R. Daniel. 2020. "The European Union's Authoritarian Equilibrium." *Journal of European Public Policy* 27(3): 481-499.
3. Current policy briefs on the candidacies of Ukraine, Moldova, Georgia, and the Western Balkan states will be posted to Brightspace.

   Recommended: Vachudova, Milada Anna. 2020. "Ethnopopulism and Democratic Backsliding in Central Europe." *East European Politics* 36(3): 318-340.

Russia's full-scale invasion of Ukraine revived enlargement as a geopolitical question and produced candidate status for Ukraine and Moldova at unusual speed. This week weighs the possibilities against the constraints: absorption capacity, the budgetary weight of extending the Common Agricultural Policy and cohesion funds eastward, unanimity rules that let a single member state stall the process, enlargement fatigue among publics, and the rule-of-law lesson of Hungary and Poland, which Kelemen argues the EU's own institutions helped entrench. Vachudova's recommended piece ties the backsliding problem back to the identity politics running through the whole course. Would admitting new members require the EU to reform itself first?

Week 14: The EU in the World

Monday (11/23): The EU as a global actor: trade and Normative Power Europe: Manners' claim and its critics; The Brussels Effect: market power as world power.

Wednesday (11/25): Thanksgiving Break, no class.

Friday (11/27): Thanksgiving Break, no class.

Readings:

1. Chapter 9, "The EU in the World."
2. Manners, Ian. 2002. "Normative Power Europe: A Contradiction in Terms?" *Journal of Common Market Studies* 40(2): 235-258.
3. Nicolaïdis, Kalypso. 2015. "Southern Barbarians? A Post-Colonial Critique of EUniversalism." In *Echoes of Empire: Memory, Identity and Colonial Legacies*, eds. Kalypso Nicolaïdis, Berny Sèbe, and Gabrielle Maas. London: I.B. Tauris.

   Recommended: Damro, Chad. 2012. "Market Power Europe." *Journal of European Public Policy* 19(5): 682-699.

   Recommended: Adib-Moghaddam, Arshin. 2017. *Psycho-nationalism: Global Thought, Iranian Imaginations*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.

   Recommended: Ndlovu-Gatsheni, Sabelo J. 2022. "European War and Global South Perspectives." *CODESRIA Bulletin Online*, No. 11.

   Recommended: Bradford, Anu. 2020. *The Brussels Effect: How the European Union Rules the World*. Oxford: Oxford University Press (introduction).

   Recommended:

   Recommended: Alcazar III, Antonio Salvador M., Camille Nessel, and Jan Orbie. 2023. "Decolonising EU Trade Relations with the Global Souths?" *Journal of Contemporary European Research* 19(2): 181-206.

What kind of power is the EU? Does the EU shape norms or merely compliance? Manners argues it is a normative power, one that shapes world politics by defining what counts as normal. Bradford's recommended reading offers the strongest current rival account: the EU externalizes its rules through market size, because for global firms complying twice is more expensive than complying with Brussels everywhere. Test both claims against what we learned in the migration and enlargement units.

Week 15: Futures of Europe

Monday (11/30): Differentiated integration: the intermediate states between out and in.

Wednesday (12/2): Course synthesis: identity, crisis, and expansion as one story.

Friday (12/4): Final paper workshop and open question session.

Readings:

1. No new required readings. Use this week to complete your final paper.

   Recommended: Leuffen, Dirk, Berthold Rittberger, and Frank Schimmelfennig. 2013. *Differentiated Integration: Explaining Variation in the European Union*. Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan (chapter 1).

Final papers are due to Brightspace by Monday, 12/14 at 11:59PM EST.

Wellness & Support Statement

Stony Brook values student well-being, including mental health, and recognizes that a variety of factors can impact emotional wellness and academic success including stress, anxiety, depression, substance use, sexual violence, family or relationship concerns, and political conflict. Resources are available if you experience challenges or wellness concerns that affect your ability to be successful in class, and you are encouraged to reach out for help when you need it.

In the event of a short-term absence from class, students are encouraged to communicate immediately and work directly with instructors. However, if a student is struggling with an extended absence due a hospitalization, family illness or death, they are encouraged to reach out to the Student Support Team.

Privacy Policies

This course utilizes various educational technologies to enhance the learning experience. You can access links to the privacy policies of the tools and platforms used at Stony Brook University on the Syllabus Addendum webpage.

Course Policies

Plagiarism and cheating are breaches of the standard codes of academic honesty, offenses that will be treated very seriously. Copying or appropriating someone else's work or handing in work previously graded constitutes academic dishonesty, as does submitting work generated by LLMs or AI. Your work will be carefully assessed for originality. Do not try it. Academic dishonesty and cheating will be pursued with disciplinary action and will result in an "F" grade for the course.

Do Not Use AI Text in Your Writing

Submitting text you did not write for a grade is plagiarism. Do not use text generated by artificial intelligence such as ChatGPT, Claude, or other, similar tools. Do not use online pay-for-product writing services. The text in your papers and presentations must be written by you. AI services generate text that fits patterns and often does not provide quality output.

Late Work Policy

Late assignments will be subject to 5% penalty per day, including Saturdays and Sundays. Assignments which are more than a week late may not be accepted.

Attendance Policy

This is an in-person course and attendance at lecture is expected. I will not take roll at every session, but the Week 11 debate and participation credit both require you to be in the room, and the lectures cover material and applications that go beyond the readings. If you must miss a session, you are responsible for the material covered; get notes from a classmate if possible and come to office hours with questions. Repeated unexplained absence will be reflected in your participation grade. I have made every effort to make the course enjoyable, and it is free of "busywork". I am not here to waste your time, and all coursework builds on itself, so please attend.

University Policies

Student Accessibility Support Center Statement

If you have a physical, psychological, medical, or learning disability that may impact your course work, please contact the Student Accessibility Support Center, Stony Brook Union Suite 107, (631) 632-6748, or at sasc@stonybrook.edu. They will determine with you what accommodations are necessary and appropriate. All information and documentation is confidential.

Students who require assistance during emergency evacuation are encouraged to discuss their needs with their professors and the Student Accessibility Support Center. For procedures and information go to the following website: https://ehs.stonybrook.edu//programs/fire-safety/emergency-evacuation/evacuation-guide-disabilities and search Fire Safety and Evacuation and Disabilities.

Academic Integrity Statement

Each student must pursue his or her academic goals honestly and be personally accountable for all submitted work. Representing another person's work as your own is always wrong. Faculty is required to report any suspected instances of academic dishonesty to the Academic Judiciary. Faculty in the Health Sciences Center (School of Health Professions, Nursing, Social Welfare, Dental Medicine) and School of Medicine are required to follow their school-specific procedures. For more comprehensive information on academic integrity, including categories of academic dishonesty please refer to the academic judiciary website at http://www.stonybrook.edu/commcms/academic_integrity/index.html

Critical Incident Management

Stony Brook University expects students to respect the rights, privileges, and property of other people. Faculty are required to report to the Office of Student Conduct and Community Standards any disruptive behavior that interrupts their ability to teach, compromises the safety of the learning environment, or inhibits students' ability to learn. Faculty in the HSC Schools and the School of Medicine are required to follow their school-specific procedures. Further information about most academic matters can be found in the Undergraduate Bulletin, the Undergraduate Class Schedule, and the Faculty-Employee Handbook.

Understand When You May Drop This Course

If you need to drop or withdraw from the course, it is your responsibility to be aware of the tuition liability deadlines listed on the registrar's Academic Calendar. Before making the decision to drop/withdraw you may want to contact me or refer to the University's policies: Undergraduate Course Load and Course Withdrawal Policy.

Incomplete Policy

Under emergency/special circumstances, students may petition for an incomplete grade. Circumstances must be documented and significant enough to merit an incomplete. If you need to request an incomplete for this course, contact me for approval as far in advance as possible. You should also read the University's policies that apply to you: Undergraduate Bulletin.